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**Revision Date:**
February 1, 2025

**Background:**
A Social Security Number (SSN) is a condition of eligibility for CalWORKs.

**Purpose:**
This section outlines the CalWORKs policies on SSN requirements. The purpose of this revision is for sunset review. There is no policy change.

**Policy:**
As a condition of eligibility, each member of the CalWORKs Assistance Unit (AU) shall provide a SSN or proof of application for a SSN prior to benefit approval. Customers must provide their SSN or proof of application for a SSN within 30 days following the application date.

Exception to SSN Requirement
The following customers can be aided without a SSN or proof of application for a SSN when acceptable documentation is provided to show that they meet the status of a specific noncitizen population:

- Cuban/Haitian Entrants. Refer to CalWORKs Program Memo 19-08 Addendum A for more information.
- Noncitizen victims of human trafficking, domestic violence, or other serious crimes. Refer to CalWORKs Program Guide (CPG) 70-100.A – Trafficking and Crime Victims Assistance Program (TCVAP).

SSN Verification
A SSN may be verified by viewing any of the following:

- An actual SSN card.
- A Social Security Administration (SSA) award letter.
- Other documentation from SSA showing the customer's name and SSN.
- The Income Eligibility Verification System (IEVS).
- The Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS) showing code "A" in the SSN verified field.

**Note:** The SSA discontinued providing SSN printouts. Customers are not required to provide a SSN printout as verification of a SSN.

The following is acceptable verification for a SSN application:

- Proof of application for a SSN accepted by the SSA for processing.
- Receipt of a SSN application for a newborn (Form SSA-2853 *Enumeration at Birth Receipt*) if it contains the name of the newborn as well as the date and signature of an authorized hospital official.

If form SSA-2853 is provided for a newborn, acceptable verification of the SSN must be received within 6 months after receiving the SSN or at redetermination, whichever occurs first.

Form I-765 *Application for Employment Authorization* can be used as proof of verification that the individual applied for SSN for the following noncitizen population:

| Individuals who have been granted: | For more information, refer to: |
|---|---|
| Humanitarian Parolee from Afghanistan (HPA) | CalWORKs Program Memo 21-13 Addendum A |
| New Special Immigrant (SI) Conditional Permanent Resident (CPR) status | CalWORKs Program Memo 21-13 Addendum A |
| Ukrainian Humanitarian Parolee (UHP) | CalWORKs Program Memo 22-06 Errata |

SSN Discrepancies

All SSNs must be verified by SSA through IEVS. Customers must cooperate with the county and SSA in resolving any discrepancies regarding SSNs. If a discrepancy cannot be resolved by the customer or review of the IEVS, a referral must be made to SSA. Failure to cooperate will result in denial or discontinuance of aid for those AU members whose SSN is in question.

Refusal to Cooperate in Providing or Applying for a SSN

When a customer refuses to provide or apply for a SSN, the customer is ineligible for CalWORKs. The same regulation will apply for children. A child will be ineligible for CalWORKs when the parent or caretaker relative, who has care and control of the child, refuses to provide or apply for a SSN on behalf of the child. If the only eligible AU member is a child who does not meet the SSN requirement, the entire AU is ineligible.

**References:**

Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 40-105, 40-107(g)
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-24-15
Medi-Cal Eligibility Division Information Letter (MEDIL) I-10-03

**Sunset Date:**

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by February 29, 2028.

**Approval for Release:**



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Self-Sufficiency Services